that I’m any slower than anybody else on the field. Basically I’m going to keep on playing for as long as I can. As I’ve said, hopefully that will be for another four to six years. I’m still amped to hit big scores, and I’m particularly motivated by the 20-over format of the game, of which I’m going to be playing a lot.

Cricket has been my life; it’s the only life I’ve known, so obviously I want to carry on playing for as long as I can. When my international career is over – and it looks like it won’t go on past the World Cup in 2011 – I reckon I’ll focus primarily on 20-over cricket. Hopefully I can divide my time between the Cape Cobras, an IPL franchise and a county cricket T20 team. And, of course, Lashings Cricket Club.

A few more Lashings would be great too

Lashings CC is a wonderful institution. I’ve been involved with the club for the past few years. Lashings began in 1984 as the brainchild of English businessman David Folb, who started a pub team in Maidstone, Kent, playing in the local village league. David then expanded his business interests to Antigua in 1995, where he met West Indies captain Richie Richardson, who was just about to retire. Lashings really took off from their collaboration.

Richie still wanted to play cricket, but he was looking for something chilled-out and fun. I think David asked him, jokingly, to come and play for his pub side back in the UK … and Richie said yes. Or probably, ‘Yeah, mon.’ From there on Lashings grew and started attracting big-name players – both active and retired. The club basically plays exhibition matches against schoolboy, club and county teams, and it is obviously a helluva thrill for these club or schoolboy cricketers to play against the biggest names in the business.

These days Lashings CC also has quite a few sponsors on board. One of them is an auction company for sports memorabilia, and before every game a big auction takes place for which corporates buy tables, which is how Lashings makes money for the sponsors and the club. David is obviously quite wealthy, and the club makes enough money to pay the players pretty well. These games take place in a relaxed atmosphere, and at lunch the team is split up so that the players can socialise with the guests. And if the players feel like a beer or two at lunch time – which they often do – then they go ahead and have a beer or two. It’s really chilled.